



◀ PINK TIDE

Since the end of the 20th century, some Latin American countries have chosen governments that support social reform—a wave called the “pink tide.” Hugo Chávez, who took power in Venezuela in 1999, was the first elected leader under this wave. In 2006, Evo Morales (left) became the first Indigenous president of Bolivia. He held that post for 13 years, during which he started programs to reduce illiteracy, poverty, and racism.

FACT

The constitutions of both Costa Rica and Panama forbid them from having a standing army, although both have civilian forces.

▼ RECLAIMING ANCESTRAL LAND

The lifestyles of Indigenous peoples are under threat as their land is exploited by oil companies, loggers, miners, and farmers. But some Indigenous groups have successfully fought to reclaim their ancestral land. In 2019, the Waorani people of Ecuador (below) won a landmark victory when a court ruled that their land could not be sold to oil companies without their permission.



CONFLICTS AND COUPS

1964

Military rule is established in Brazil. The government improves the economy but bans all opposition. The dictatorship lasts till 1985.

1973

In Chile, the democratically elected government led by Salvador Allende is overthrown in a military coup by General Pinochet.

1980

The communist Sendero Luminoso (Shining Path) group begins a revolutionary war in Peru.

1982

The military government of Argentina invades the British-held Falkland Islands but is defeated. Argentines protest against the government, and Argentina returns to democratic rule in 1983.



1989–90

The US invades Panama, deposing dictator Manuel Noriega.

LATIN AMERICAN CULTURE ▼

Latin America is renowned for its music and dance. The Argentine tango (right) became known throughout the world in the early 20th century and has had a revival since the 1980s. The region's many notable writers include Colombian Gabriel García Márquez and Chilean novelist Isabel Allende.

